THE MASTER KNOWLEDGE BASE

FOR HUMAN TEAMS + AI RESEARCH AGENTS

NEXUS TECHNOLOGY CUP

2026 / COMPETITION INTELLIGENCE

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE

Do not pitch a future idea. Prove that a real technology works, that the problem matters, and that the original engineering is hard to copy.

SOURCE-BASED + AGENT-READY

What Nexus is. Complete eligibility and prize rules. Four judging dimensions. The application and selection process. Verified 2025 winners and technical lessons. A reproducible idea-generation, validation and build workflow. Session timeline, uncertainties and source links.

RESEARCH DATE	APPLICATION DEADLINE
08 OCT 2026	**25 OCT 2026, 11:59 PM CT**

Prepared as a searchable, citation-labeled dossier. Facts, inferences and unknowns are intentionally distinguished throughout.

READER MAP / RESEARCH + ACTION

How to use this dossier

This PDF has three jobs: provide verified Nexus rules, dissect what previously won, and give a research/coding agent a rigorous process for creating an honest prototype. Use the navigation bookmarks in a PDF reader to jump between sections.

01 THE COMPETITION

00-02 Executive brief, organization, rules and track eligibility

03-06 Four judge criteria, real application and presentation

02 THE BENCHMARK

07-12 2025 judges, champions, finalists and verified case studies

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03 THE EXECUTION

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20-23 Agent research prompts, implementation and application writing

24-26 Session timeline, open questions and source URLs

KEY SOURCE MARKERS

[T] Info session | [E] Organizer email | [W] Linked reporting
[A] Analysis or proposed workflow: NOT a formal competition rule

Executive decision brief

Read this page first. It captures the highest-impact competition facts and the decision rule for project selection.

Nexus Technology Cup is a Louisiana-based technology demonstration competition organized by Nexus Louisiana, a nonprofit technology incubator established in 1992. It rewards functioning prototypes, not just startup business plans. The 2026 contest adds a dedicated High School Track to College and Open Tracks. [W1, W6, T]

NON-NEGOTIABLE

Show something working. The October 2 session distinguished Tech Cup from pitch competitions. A slide deck about what could exist later is not a strong entry. A working input-to-output demonstration is the core bar for consideration. [T 05:00-07:10]

OCT 25 DEADLINE | DEC 14-16 FINALS | $150K PRIZE POOL | MAX 4 TEAM MEMBERS

What the judges actually prioritize

01 **Impact**
Is the problem consequential and potentially widely relevant?

02 **Difficulty**
Did the team solve a genuinely hard technical problem?

03 **Novelty**
How is the technology different from obvious existing approaches?

04 **Feasibility**
Is it real, credible, and capable of advancing with support?

IMPORTANT QUALIFICATION

No official numerical weights, minimum score, proprietary rubric, or exact tie-break rules were published in the information session or sources reviewed. Do not present a homemade weighting as official. [T 07:50-11:50]

Recommended next action for a college junior

Choose College Track if enrolled at a Louisiana institution, secure a faculty advisor, confirm a team of 1 to 4, identify your unique technical contribution, build a stable demo, collect evidence, and submit a shareable team video and screenshots before the cutoff. [W1, W2, T]

What Nexus Louisiana is and why this Cup exists

Institutional background for an AI agent that must reason about mission alignment.

Nexus Louisiana is a Baton Rouge-based nonprofit formed in 1992 to advance high-tech industry, research and entrepreneurship in Louisiana. It connects builders with coaching, capital pathways, workspace, startup networks and partners. The current organizational framing emphasizes practical technologies addressing real challenges and helping founders turn prototypes into impact. [W6, W7]

Origin story from the October 2 session

- President and CEO Tony Zanders described growing up with a school-to-regional-to-state science-fair tradition in Louisiana. He wanted a modern, technology-centered platform that celebrates builders instead of science-fair posters. [T 00:00-05:00]
- Tech Cup is intended to showcase work developed throughout the year. A deliberately short gap between applications and finals is not enough time to create a substantial technology from zero. [T 05:00-06:00]
- The event provides a stage where state decision-makers, technical judges, employers and potential funders can evaluate actual prototypes. [T 27:15-34:00]

Nexus ecosystem around the competition

Program or asset	Role / relevance
Tech Cup	Broad multi-industry prototype showcase and competition.
DevDays	Smaller events that often have an industry theme. Past student finalists were encouraged to enter Tech Cup.
Membership and incubation	Mentorship, capital connections and support after the competition.
Tech Tailgates / community events	Networking with founders and Nexus staff before the submission cutoff.

How this shapes project selection

Mission fit is not a separate disclosed scoring dimension, but work that solves a serious, demonstrated user problem and could travel beyond one neighborhood is easier to argue under opportunity for impact. The competition explicitly has no required industry theme. Healthcare, agriculture, energy, environment, construction, cybersecurity and education were mentioned as examples, not mandatory categories. [T 07:50-09:00, 15:45-17:05]

Evidence: [T] session transcript; [W6] Nexus About; [W7] Nexus anniversary history.

2026 rules, dates and track choice

Use these verified operational facts. Recheck official pages before final submission.

Dates and venue

Item	2026 status
Application deadline	**Sunday October 25, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. Central Time.** Source: user email and reporting from September/October 2026.
Finals	**December 14-16, 2026**, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. at Nexus HQ, Baton Rouge, per current official site.
Selection communication	Organizers said they expect semifinalists about one week after the Oct 25 deadline. Exact notification dates not guaranteed.
Earlier conflicting materials	The session verbally referenced December 12; current official site and current reporting say December 14-16. Use current official site.

Who can enter

Track	Eligibility and specific notes
College	Current students at a Louisiana college, university or technical school; undergraduate or graduate per site; interdisciplinary teams and students at different Louisiana institutions permitted; faculty advisor required.
Open	Louisiana-based entrepreneurs, professionals, independent developers and startups; prototype or beyond. Organizers said students may compete up, but not vice versa.
High School	Louisiana public/private or home-school students; student-led technology; teacher/faculty advisor; clubs eligible.

TRACK RECOMMENDATION FOR A JUNIOR

College Track generally makes sense for an undergraduate unless the prototype is already strong enough to compare with funded companies and professional research groups. This is a strategic recommendation, not a Nexus rule. [T 16:50-19:05]

Prizes for 2026

Category	First	Second	Third
Open	$50,000	$25,000	$15,000
College	$10,000	$8,500	$5,000
High School	$5,000	$3,000	$1,000
Most Innovative	$25,000 extra	-	-

The four listed competition awards sum to $147,500: Open $90,000, College $23,500, High School $9,000 and Most Innovative $25,000. The official site separately lists $2,500 for teacher advisors, which accounts for the advertised $150,000. The email discusses $250 per high school advancing into the top 10; exact beneficiary wording differs between messages and the current page. Confirm with Nexus. [W1, E]

Prize conditions

- Most Innovative is a separate $25,000 award. The October 2 organizers said only the first-place winner in each track is eligible. A college first-place team could therefore potentially receive $35,000 total. [T 22:20-26:40]

- Prize money goes to named team members, not directly to the university. The organizers said Nexus takes no equity or IP ownership in exchange for the prize. Advisor support awards are separate. [T 19:40-21:35, 46:45-47:30]

Evidence: [W1] current official Cup page; [E] supplied email; [W5] current deadline reporting; [T] session.

The judging framework: four dimensions

This is the highest-priority section of the entire dossier. Distinguish official statements from strategic elaboration.

OFFICIAL EVALUATION DIMENSIONS

1. Opportunity for impact | 2. Degree of difficulty | 3. Novelty | 4. Feasibility. Tony Zanders identified these at approximately 07:50-11:50 in the October 2 session. No points or percentages were assigned publicly. [T]

Criterion 1. Opportunity for impact

Official meaning: Does the solution meet a need beyond the maker, neighborhood or one-off use? Could it help large groups, even internationally? The presentation does not require a proven million-user market, but it needs a credible impact opportunity. [T 07:55-08:45]

- **Evidence:** clear target user, interview or survey insights, published prevalence/scale data, current workaround, quantified time/cost/safety problem, plausible adoption pathway.
- **Weak:** "everyone needs this" or "AI will revolutionize the world" without proof.
- **Strong:** "X user group currently faces Y bottleneck; here is our tested workflow that reduces the bottleneck on these examples."

Criterion 2. Degree of difficulty

Official meaning: Is there genuinely hard engineering or research? If an audience member can reproduce the project in two weeks with readily available tools, it is less defensible. Organizers said technically intensive hardware and deep tech may be scored more favorably than easily replicated software. [T 08:45-09:45, 38:15-40:15]

- **Evidence:** novel algorithm/architecture, specialized sensor/calibration pipeline, robust data engineering, domain constraints, experiments, advanced integration, failure analyses or real-time performance improvements.
- **Weak:** ordinary API integration with standard templates presented as a breakthrough.
- **Strong:** diagram of the hard subsystem, baseline comparison, reproducible test, and explanation of why the chosen design is necessary.

Criterion 3. Novelty

Official meaning: Is the solution meaningfully different from what already exists? Tony asked whether a judge could quickly find many similar websites through an AI search. You are not required to show a conventional business competitor slide, but you should have done that thinking. [T 09:45-10:40]

- **Evidence:** direct competitors, research papers, open-source libraries, patents if relevant, current limitations, and a clearly demonstrated technical delta.
- **Weak:** "first ever" assertions or "nobody does this" without searching.
- **Strong:** state three closest alternatives and specify what measurable problem each fails to solve.

Criterion 4. Feasibility

Official meaning: Does this technology have a credible path forward, and can the awarded capital help advance the current prototype? This is not the same as a mature revenue forecast. [T 10:40-11:50]

- **Evidence:** functional demonstration, reproducible setup, constraints, next experiment, parts/cloud costs, realistic milestones and what the prize would buy.
- **Weak:** dependency on unavailable datasets or unproven science hidden behind a polished mockup.
- **Strong:** demo works today, limitations are transparent, and the next $10,000 has identifiable technical uses.

Evidence: [T 07:50-11:50; 38:15-40:15]. All "evidence/weak/strong" examples above are advisory synthesis.

Judge simulation and evidence standards

An agent should challenge its own ideas rather than flatter them.

Eight uncomfortable judge questions

01

What did you actually build?

State the implemented core. Separate built parts, third-party services, simulated outputs and future features.

02

What is new?

Name at least three comparable solutions or papers and the specific technical delta.

03

Why is this difficult?

Explain technical constraints, engineering effort and why a simple baseline cannot reach the same result.

04

How do you know it works?

Show a small reproducible evaluation with realistic samples and failure cases.

05

Who needs it?

Identify a user group and evidence of a painful workflow or unmet need.

06

Can it scale?

Describe architectural and operational limits without inventing traction.

07

What will prize money change?

Budget the next prototype milestone, not an imaginary global rollout.

08

Can you repeat this demo?

Document setup, dependencies, safe example data, fallback video and recovery path.

SCORING IS UNOFFICIAL

Use a private 0-to-5 score for each official criterion and optional "demo readiness" or "team fit" gates, but label the scoring as a decision aid. It is not the Nexus scorecard. Reject ideas that cannot achieve a real demonstration before the application cutoff.

Recommended evidence packet

- A **working artifact**: build, prototype link, recording or functional hardware.
- An **architecture diagram**: inputs, processing, novel contribution, outputs, dependencies.
- A **comparison table**: baseline, competitors, tested difference, source for every claim.
- An **evaluation record**: test set, metric definition, actual results, limitations and failure examples.
- An **implementation log**: what each teammate built, timestamps or commits, help from mentors.

Application mechanics and submission checklist

The live 2026 Jotform was checked through the official Nexus application link on October 8, 2026.

The form explicitly says its overview is used to qualify applications that advance to the semifinals, emphasizing **novelty, development difficulty and potential impact**. It auto-saves progress, but you are not entered until you press **Submit**. [W2]

Questions and assets that must be prepared

Application section	What the form asks
Identity / track	Team lead contact, role, project/product name, track, school and advisor details.
Core written answers	Problem statement; what is innovative and how it works; target customer/user.
Evidence	Shareable team video explaining functioning product/prototype, plus high-resolution prototype photos/screenshots.
Readiness	Patent status; actual or estimated build cost; estimated build time; investment interest and startup stage.
People and media	Team photo, project social profiles where applicable, team lead and teammate contacts.
Attestations	Original work certification, communication permissions and media release selections.

Team and advisor rules

- **Maximum team size:** the current application asks for 1, 2, 3 or 4 people. [W2]
- **Faculty advisor:** required for College and High School Tracks. The form permits "N/A" in advisor name if asking for assistance locating one. Still try to confirm early. [W1, W2]
- **Prize eligibility:** Na'Tisha said team members not listed on the application would not receive a portion of the winnings. Confirm team membership and contact details before submitting. [T 46:45-47:30]
- **Originality:** the form includes a certification that submitted work is original and solely the product of the team. Ask organizers how assistance, open-source code and third-party AI tools should be disclosed if unclear. [W2]

Submission integrity checks

- [ ] **Demo video is viewable**

  Open the share link in a logged-out browser window and test playback.

- [ ] **Screenshots prove function**

  Capture real screens and annotate input, core operation and output.

- [ ] **Every teammate is included**

  Verify 1 to 4 names, email addresses and roles.

- [ ] **Advisor is arranged or clearly requested**

  Verify institution and advisor email or assistance request.

- [ ] **Claims are traceable**

  Do not invent user interviews, accuracy figures or product originality.

- [ ] **Final confirmation received**

  Submit early and keep a receipt or confirmation.

Evidence: [W2] live Jotform application; [W1] official Cup page; [T 46:45-47:30].

Selection, finals and presentation format

The finalist showcase is substantially different from a conventional investor pitch.

Selection pipeline described in the session

01 **Application**

Submit online before October 25. The video and written description are used in initial selection.

02 **Initial review**

Nexus evaluates applications, with semifinalists expected roughly within one week after the cutoff.

03 **Semifinal review**

Organizers said semifinalists undergo another review, but did not publish a fixed interview script or exact elimination numbers.

04 **Top 10 per track**

Organizers announced an intended 10 finalists per track in 2026, giving 30 finalists overall.

05

Final-stage demo

Present working technology to industry judges and an audience at Nexus HQ in Baton Rouge.

Onstage structure explicitly confirmed

Element	Confirmed expectation
Stage format	In-person audience, judges on the side, teams demonstrating on venue screens.
Time limit	10 minutes for presentation and demo plus 5 minutes for judge Q&A.;
Slides	Allowed to explain the problem, motivation, development process and technical evidence. They cannot replace demonstrating the technology.
Demo mode	Working live demo preferred in spirit; prerecorded demo explicitly permitted to avoid latency or connection failure.
Coaching	Finalists are assigned a Nexus expert coach for demo strategy and rehearsal.

Suggested 10-minute presentation blueprint (NOT official)

Time	Purpose
00:00-01:00	Problem and user, with proof of why it matters.
01:00-02:00	What is genuinely new in the approach.
02:00-06:30	Demonstrate functioning technology. Show real inputs and outputs.
06:30-08:00	Architecture, difficult engineering, what the team built.
08:00-09:00	Test evidence, closest existing alternatives and results.
09:00-10:00	Feasibility, limits, next milestone and use of the prize.

DO NOT REVERSE THE EMPHASIS

Slides provide context. The working prototype is the hero. A 10-minute presentation containing zero functioning product demonstration was explicitly described as unlikely to score well. [T 41:45-46:40]

Evidence: [T 40:30-46:45], [W1] official venue and dates.

2025 evidence baseline: who competed and judged

The 2025 event was the first year. It is useful precedent, not a promise about 2026.

The inaugural 2025 Tech Cup took place June 17-19 at The Estuary / Water Campus in Baton Rouge. The official June 2025 judges announcement reported 74 applications, 44 semifinalists and 21 finalists. Another June press account reported more than 80 applicants, and the October 2026 session summarized more than 75 submissions. These reported counts conflict, so use the dated primary-source count when discussing the formal 2025 funnel. [W3, W4, T]

Documented 2025 judges

Person	Background in official announcement
Angie Jones	Global VP of Developer Relations at Block.
Padma Vatsavai	Founder and CEO of Vinformatix.
Dianna Liu	Founder and President of ARIX Technologies, robotic inspection.
Jason Varghese	Amazon technology leader and cloud/apps architect.
Karl Reid, PhD	Former MIT vice president, engineering education leader.

These are **2025 judges**, not a confirmed 2026 panel. The 2025 college final article specifically names Jones, Vatsavai and Liu as that stage panel. [W3, W4]

What the 2025 judging roster suggests (inference)

- Explain the core in plain English without losing engineering precision. Some judges bring business and education backgrounds; others have deep software or industrial technical expertise.
- Prepare for cross-disciplinary questions about impact, reproducibility, data privacy and technical limitations.
- A polished project story is valuable, but founders said a real demo matters more than conventional pitch polish.

Evidence: [W3] official 2025 judge announcement; [W4] official 2025 College Track results.

2025 champion case study: Encore CO2

Open Track first place AND Most Innovative Award in the inaugural 2025 competition.

VERIFIED OUTCOME

Encore CO2 won 2025 Open Track first place and Most Innovative, receiving a combined **$45,000** under the 2025 prize structure. The October 2 speaker informally recalled a different amount, so the contemporaneous June reporting is used for the actual 2025 figure. [W8, W9]

Team and problem

Public reporting identifies founders Jordan Losavio, William McGehee and John Flake, with Monsuru Dauda also named on the official finalist roster. Their technology focuses on transforming captured carbon dioxide into useful products instead of treating emissions solely as waste. [W8, W10]

What they built or demonstrated

- **Technology:** carbon-conversion work aiming to convert captured CO2 into ethanol and other higher-value outputs. The company described potential applications in consumer goods, pharmaceuticals and manufacturing. [W8, T 23:05-24:45]
- **Actual demonstrated artifact:** Tony described the team bringing a carbon-derived alcoholic lemonade/seltzer product for judges to experience while explaining their technology. Contemporary reporting also described beverage production using captured local brewery emissions. [T 23:05-24:45, W8]
- **Credibility:** reporting noted NSF and Louisiana FUEL research support, suggesting significant development work before the competition, not an overnight prototype. [W8]

Why it plausibly aligned with the four criteria (analysis)

Criterion	Evidence or inference
Impact	Carbon emissions are a major industrial issue, and carbon utilization is potentially cross-industry. This relevance was discussed by Tony.
Difficulty	Chemical engineering, process chemistry and conversion validation are specialized technical disciplines.
Novelty	The application of captured CO2 to a tangible market-facing product made the approach concrete; novelty versus all chemical methods still requires formal research.
Feasibility	Judges could engage with a physical demonstration, and preexisting funding indicated technical momentum.

Presentation lesson and limitation

Confirmed: a physical product and technical explanation were shown, per the session. **Not confirmed:** exact slide order, presenter speaking time, chemistry protocol, complete judge Q&A; or scored judging sheet. No publicly accessible full stage recording was verified during this research. Do not invent those details.

Evidence: [T 23:05-24:45], [W8] Business Report, [W9] Technical.ly, [W10] official finalists.

2025 college winner: FarmSmarter.AI / FarmMind

The most useful direct comparison for a college AI/software project.

VERIFIED OUTCOME

LSU team **FarmSmarter.AI** won the 2025 College Track first prize of **$15,000**. Current coverage calls the product FarmMind, formerly FarmSmarter.AI. The 2026 college first prize is $10,000. [W4, W9]

Who built it

Grant Muslow, Colin Raby, Julius Pallotta and Cole Lacombe, advised by Dr. Fahimeh Abbasi at LSU. The 2025 official results identify all four. [W4]

What the technology does

- AI assistant for agricultural professionals, with capabilities described as plant identification, issue diagnosis, and decision support. [W4]

- LSU describes its Farmer AI assistant synthesizing university agricultural research, regulatory rules and EPA-approved pesticide/herbicide labels to help develop crop-management guidance. [W11]
- During the session Tony emphasized the difficulty of agricultural documentation and regulations and described using weather and geographic information to inform local decisions. [T 24:45-26:30]

What is known about its development and presentation

LSU reports that the concept began in an LLM development class, then the team used advisor support, research resources, mentor introductions and startup competitions to refine it. The official Tech Cup result confirms a judged finalist appearance but does not publish the exact software screen flow, slides or demo transcript. [W11, W4]

What another team should learn (analysis)

- The domain problem is concrete: specialized regulations, research and agricultural decision-making. It is not framed as a generic chat assistant.
- The hard part to investigate is source accuracy, regulatory grounding, updates and domain-specific workflow quality. Those are testable technical claims.
- A new agri-assistant idea must differentiate from FarmMind and many other existing agriculture platforms. Do not simply reproduce the winner with a different interface.

POSSIBLE LIVE DEMO RECONSTRUCTION, NOT A HISTORICAL CLAIM

A sensible educational reconstruction would load an example farm scenario, retrieve locally relevant approved documentation, explain an actionable answer with source citations and show an evaluation or failure case. There is **no evidence** that the winners used this exact presentation structure.

Evidence: [W4] official student results; [W11] LSU university feature; [T 24:45-26:30].

Other 2025 winners: college and open

See the full winner ecosystem, not just the two headline teams.

College Track: 2nd place, APNE

Team: led by Mehrasa Amiri, advised by LSU professor Mahmood Jasim. **2025 award:** $10,000. **System:** combines AI and human review or crowdsourcing to identify bias or misinformation in online news. Related 2025 CHI research by Mehrasa Amiri Besheli and Mahmood Jasim is publicly indexed. [W4, W12]

Lesson (analysis): A hybrid human + algorithm system may differentiate through escalation decisions, evidence transparency and calibration, but competition-specific architecture and stage demonstration details were not publicly verified.

College Track: 3rd place, Dristi

Team: Unika Bista and Divya Shah from University of Louisiana Monroe, advised by Dr. Prasanthi Sreekumari. **2025 award:** $5,000. **System:** AI-powered real-time scene descriptions to aid users with visual impairments. [W4, W13]

Lesson (analysis): Accessibility creates clear impact, but practical reliability requires careful evaluation of descriptions, latency, privacy, error severity and operation in unusual scenes. Public articles did not reveal their technical benchmarks.

Open Track: 2nd place, Unknown Cyber

Team: UL Lafayette-linked cybersecurity researchers, including Arun Lakhotia and colleagues named on the finalist roster. **System:** AI-driven genomic threat detection to protect software supply chains and critical systems. [W8, W10]

Lesson (analysis): Deep domain methods and sophisticated threat-analysis workflows can demonstrate technical difficulty. Do not confuse published product claims with independently reproduced detection accuracy.

Open Track: 3rd place, MilestoneMate

Founder: Shay Claiborne, New Orleans. **System:** platform for early childhood development milestone tracking and customized guidance for families and professionals. [W8]

Lesson (analysis): A software solution can place highly when it addresses an important workflow and offers meaningful utility. No public exact demo storyboard or ranking sheet was verified.

Evidence: [W4] official college winners; [W8] independent winners report; [W12] scholarly publication; [W13] ULM news.

2025 demonstrations, finalists and patterns

Breadth of submissions helps an AI agent avoid repeating obvious ideas.

High school exhibition projects from 2025

Team	Verified demonstration
Hexlio / Benjamin Namikas	Productivity app combining task management and distraction reduction. 2025 invited exhibitor, received $2,500.
POSEIDON / Ren Hopkins, Aiden Bass, Brady Afeman	Custom robot engineered by student team at West Monroe High School. 2025 invited exhibitor, received $2,500.

Other named College Track finalists in official 2025 roster

Aeero (Grambling State), **Autism Speaks AI** (ULM), **Donor Sync** (ULM), **Respir APPtion** (UL Lafayette), **Rhyme AI** (ULM), and **Solara** (University of New Orleans), alongside APNE, Dristi and FarmSmarter.AI. Most project technical descriptions were not available from the official roster; do not manufacture specifications from names alone. [W10]

Other named Open Track finalists

Build-A-Way (voice AI for contractor scheduling and invoicing), **Cinelevels**, **DarQ Security**, **Flange Aligner**, **Jammaround**, **QueryLake**, **Trendsic**, **Zepity**, and the five named Open winners or other finalists. The official roster verifies names, while Build-A-Way descriptions are supported by independent press and the company. Do not infer the unspecified teams' capabilities. [W10, W14]

Patterns we can safely infer from the examples

- The competition spans chemical engineering, software security, AI systems, accessibility, agriculture, robotics, parent support, productivity and contractor workflows.
- Both AI software and physical technology can place. Judges assess technical specificity, real-world usefulness and credible demonstration, not a single preferred industry.
- Student-built solutions can compete meaningfully, especially when they combine technical development with faculty and subject-matter mentorship.

RESEARCH GAP: PAST PRESENTATION VIDEOS

The October 2 2026 rules specify a 10-minute demo and 5-minute Q&A;, and one 2025 Encore example describes a tangible beverage demonstration. Search results did **not** establish publicly accessible full 2025 stage videos, precise slide decks, complete Q&A; exchanges or numeric individual judge scores. Treat any detailed presentation reconstruction as hypothetical.

Evidence: [W4, W8, W10, W14]; [T 41:45-46:45, 23:05-24:45].

Lessons from past teams: what to imitate, not copy

Distill recurring strengths into a practical product-review lens.

Case study	Transferable design lesson	Danger to avoid
Encore CO2	Make a hard technical breakthrough tangible and demonstrate it physically.	Do not attempt wet-lab claims without facilities and proof.
FarmMind	Use credible domain sources and tackle a specialized decision workflow.	Do not create another vague agritech chatbot.
APNE	Combine AI with human review when credibility and verification matter.	Do not claim zero misinformation errors.
Dristi	Show immediate user value in a clear real-world accessibility workflow.	Do not imply safety-critical reliability without tests.
Unknown Cyber	Expose a unique hard technical subsystem, not just a dashboard.	Do not invent threat-detection performance.
MilestoneMate	Make a complex real-world support process easier to navigate.	Do not overclaim medical or developmental advice.

The competitor comparison test

For each proposed idea, research five buckets before claiming novelty: **(1)** direct consumer/commercial products, **(2)** open-source solutions, **(3)** peer-reviewed research, **(4)** government/university prototypes, and **(5)** prior Tech Cup or Nexus DevDays entries. Save URLs, publish dates, screenshots, constraints and a direct comparison. An idea is not novel because the team has never heard of it.

What a defensible technical advantage looks like

- A verified capability competitors lack for your chosen population or environment.
- A measurable improvement in error rate, latency, privacy, cost, robustness or interpretability.
- A new algorithm, sensor integration, data-validation technique or hard deployment constraint.
- An original integration that solves a previously unaddressed engineering bottleneck, not merely combining APIs.

Brainstorming: how an AI agent should search

Generate grounded project hypotheses, not grandiose startup slogans.

Start from pain, not from technology

01

Find a user with a painful workflow

Look at public agencies, teachers, farmers, clinics, families, industrial operators, accessibility groups, small businesses or university labs. Do not pretend interviews happened.

02

Measure the problem

Identify an observable cost, delay, error, safety risk or unmet need. Use citations for statistics.

03

Identify the technical bottleneck

Find the reason existing solutions fail: missing data, poor robustness, hard environments, domain rules, latency, auditability, price or poor UX.

04

Check what already exists

Collect close products, demos, papers, patents and available code before naming novelty.

05

Define a 7-day proof

Specify an end-to-end working demonstration using available tools and lawful, permissioned data.

06

Invent a test

Define a small benchmark or repeatable evaluation that can expose both wins and failures.

07

Kill weak ideas early

Reject concept-only ideas, unsupported clinical/safety claims, unavailable hardware, secret data and indistinguishable API wrappers.

Good areas for exploring high-impact problems

The Nexus site broadly features healthcare access, environment/coastal resilience and education, while the session emphasized all industries are welcome. Additional plausible problem spaces include agriculture, infrastructure, disaster resilience, energy, accessibility, local logistics, software assurance and university research workflows. These are idea search spaces, not official award preferences. [W1, W6, T]

Idea bank A: evidence-first software directions

These are **unverified starting hypotheses**, not unique ideas or preapproved Nexus topics. Research competitors and data before committing.

01 Flooded-route uncertainty assistant

User: Travelers and first responders after storms. **Potential technical delta:** Fuse official road notices, flood sensor feeds and map constraints; return routes with uncertainty, not fabricated safety. **Demo: route choice with missing or contradictory reports.** Risk: real-time data availability and emergency use safeguards.

02 Accessible indoor landmark guide

User: Students and visitors with low vision. **Potential technical delta:** On-device scene recognition with confidence thresholds, map constraints and a safe fallback when uncertain. **Demo: navigate a controlled building corridor.** Risk: dataset bias, privacy and dangerous navigation overconfidence.

03 Citable student learning verifier

User: Students checking generated explanations. **Potential technical delta:** Align claims in AI explanations with page-level source spans; flag unsupported claims and benchmark false confidence. **Demo: compare grounded vs plain chatbot responses.** Risk: crowded space; specific measurable delta is necessary.

04 Construction change-order evidence analyzer

User: Small construction contractors. **Potential technical delta:** Extract requirements and revision differences from plans and written change orders with auditable source links. **Demo: change detection on two permissioned sample documents.** Risk: document complexity, confidential drawings, existing products.

05 Offline post-disaster intake sync

User: Community relief volunteers. **Potential technical delta:** Conflict-resistant offline forms, geotagged evidence and eventual consistency under low connectivity. **Demo: two devices work offline, sync and merge duplicate records.** Risk: personal data and relief distribution accuracy.

06 Regulation-aware lab procedure checker

User: University lab managers. **Potential technical delta:** Document graph across procedures, equipment capabilities and revision history; identify contradictory steps. **Demo: detect staged inconsistencies with verifiable citations.** Risk: must never replace authoritative lab safety review.

Idea bank B: harder technical / hybrid directions

Prefer a narrow, provable prototype over an expansive concept. Every entry below requires competitor verification.

07 Industrial sensor drift watchdog

User: Plant and campus facilities operators. **Potential technical delta:** Identify calibration drift in sparse or noisy low-cost sensors, with explainable anomaly confidence. **Demo: reproduce injected drift on a benchtop sensor or archived dataset.** Risk: reliable test ground truth.

08 Coastal imagery change auditor

User: Coastal researchers and local governments. **Potential technical delta:** Georegister imagery over time and quantify uncertainty in erosion/vegetation change. **Demo: compare two public imagery snapshots and flag ambiguous pixels.** Risk: remote-sensing baseline tools are mature.

09 Accessible caption accuracy evaluator

User: Classrooms and public events. **Potential technical delta:** Recognize domain words and quantify when ASR errors change the meaning of instructions. **Demo: compare different acoustic conditions on consented recordings.** Risk: generic transcription apps are widespread.

10 Supply-chain artifact provenance verifier

User: Student developer teams or small firms. **Potential technical delta:** Link dependency manifests, built binaries and signature evidence to detect unexpected changes. **Demo: tampered dependency build flagged with reproducible evidence.** Risk: cybersecurity novelty bar is high.

11 Farm label compliance audit trail

User: Agricultural advisers. **Potential technical delta:** Link plot, crop, weather constraints and pesticide label versions to auditable requirements. **Demo: controlled sample decision with citations and conflicting rules.** Risk: FarmMind is already a relevant competitor; misuse harms crops.

12 Assistive maintenance fault explainer

User: School facilities / small industrial firms. **Potential technical delta:** Use low-cost vibration/audio samples and calibrated uncertainty to distinguish common equipment faults. **Demo: seeded equipment conditions or labeled public dataset.** Risk: noisy sensing and real deployment accuracy.

ANTI-HALLUCINATION CLAUSE

None of these 12 directions is verified novel, patentable, technically feasible in your team, or likely to win. They are starting points to investigate. An agent must independently research any candidate before recommending a build.

Idea selection matrix and go/no-go gates

A structured way to reduce 12 plausible directions to 1 credible prototype.

Suggested internal scoring (not official Nexus weights)

Dimension	Rating 0-5 guide	Gate?
Impact	User severity and reach, with evidence.	No
Difficulty	Meaningful original engineering, not just interface.	Yes
Novelty	Compared with direct alternatives and research.	Yes
Feasibility	Can demonstrate today or by Oct 23 with available inputs.	Yes
Demo clarity	Judge understands result in under 90 seconds.	Yes
Data / ethics	Consent, license, security, safety and reliability.	Yes
Team / advisor fit	Available skills, equipment, mentor and time.	Yes

A useful decision convention: any candidate failing a gate is held for redesign, regardless of aggregate score. Prioritize 2 to 3 strong ideas, investigate them in parallel, then choose one. Never present the internal matrix as the judges' rubric.

Novelty audit worksheet to fill for EACH idea

- [ ] **Closest three products**

  Name, link, core features, limitations and last verified date.

- [ ] **Closest two papers or open-source projects**

  Exact citation/URL and differences in method or deployment.

- [ ] **What we do differently**

  One sentence with a falsifiable technical claim.

- [ ] **Comparison experiment**

  Metric, dataset, sample count, baseline and repeat protocol.

- [ ] **Failure modes**

  What could go wrong, including harmful use and security/privacy issues.

- [ ] **Prototype architecture**

  Inputs, core component, third-party dependencies and outputs.

- [ ] **Feasible milestones**

  What is already built, what can be done by application date, what must wait.

Build and demo execution plan: Oct 8-25

Schedule reflects the October 8 research date, leaving 17 calendar days to the Sunday deadline.

Window	Target outcome	Proof artifact
Oct 8-10	Problem framing, user evidence, competitor search, advisor and team.	Problem one-pager + rival landscape.
Oct 11-14	End-to-end skeleton with actual input, processing and output.	First working demo recording.
Oct 15-18	Strengthen hard technical component, test and evaluate.	Reproducible tests + limits log.
Oct 19-21	Freeze app for application; record video and capture screenshots.	Shareable link + screenshots.
Oct 22-23	Advisor review, proofreading, verify track and team, final submission.	Submission confirmation.
Oct 24-25	Buffer only for unexpected issues, not core feature building.	Verified confirmation already saved.

Development priorities in descending order

01 **Functional core**

One complete scenario should work deterministically with meaningful output.

02 **Defensible hard subsystem**

Demonstrate the engineering that makes it better than a generic tool.

03 **Test evidence**

Use a baseline and known examples, including at least one failure.

04 **Clear explanation**

Architecture, novelty and limits understandable to nonexperts.

05 **Safe demo operations**

No sensitive personal data, production credentials or unsafe physical actions.

06 **Visual polish**

Clean UI after the technical case is defensible.

Video capture checklist

- Show the team briefly. Define the problem and what is already built. [W2]
- Show a real workflow from an understandable input through the novel feature to the output.
- Narrate what was developed by the team and what uses external models, sensors, data or libraries.
- Use sharp readable capture, audio levels, captions if possible, sample data and a publicly accessible share link.
- Record a fallback video even if you plan a live finals demonstration. [T 44:30-45:15]

Six practical risk controls

Avoid disqualifying mistakes and protect your teammates and users.

01

Intellectual property

A patent is not mandatory or automatically rewarded. But public demonstrations can jeopardize future patentability. Consult university technology transfer if disclosure matters. [T 33:45-36:45]

02

Accuracy and domain safety

For health, farming, emergency, legal or infrastructure projects, never claim professional reliability without tests. Label prototypes and require qualified human oversight.

03

AI contributions and originality

Track team-created code and design. Disclose important third-party data, open source and hosted models where relevant; the form includes an originality affirmation. [W2]

04

Team awards

Every eligible teammate must be named on the submitted application to share prize money under the organizers' described policy. [T 46:45-47:30]

05

Data rights and privacy

Use synthetic or permissioned datasets for video and public demos. Never leak private university, patient, client or company data.

06

Honest metrics

A one-sample success is not a 99% accuracy claim. Record sample sizes, baseline definition and failure cases, and do not overstate results.

Things to ask Nexus if your plan depends on them

- Whether competing in both College and Open is allowed; session confirms competing up, not dual applications.
- What counts as permitted professional or faculty help under the originality certification?
- Whether prototype updates after submission can be demonstrated at finals, and at what stage updates must be declared.
- How the semifinal review is conducted, and whether 2026 demo logistics differ by track.
- Clarification of the high-school advisor stipend wording and the website total.

The 2025 finalist announcement lists Na'Tisha Natt as competition contact at **natisha@nexusla.org**, phone **(225) 408-5018**. Reconfirm contact details if necessary. [W10]

Finalist benefits and networking preparation

The session described meaningful benefits for all 30 finalists, even without winning prize money.

Benefits specifically mentioned

- **Technical coaching:** finalist teams get a Nexus mentor focused on demonstrating well and rehearsing. [T 45:15-46:45]
- **Judges' feedback:** expert review from startup founders and technical leaders. Historical affiliations do not guarantee the same 2026 judges. [T 28:15-29:45]
- **Earned media:** organizers said they would invite press and promote finalist projects locally and beyond. Coverage volume is not guaranteed. [T 29:45-31:15]
- **Professional content:** 2026 session promises headshots and video interviews usable in founders' own marketing. [T 31:15-32:30]
- **Curated networking:** potential employers, internships, investors, startup mentors, and institutional stakeholders. Opportunities are not automatic offers. [T 32:30-34:00]

How a student team should prepare for the attention

- [ ] **Project landing page**

  One paragraph, functioning demo clip, contact email and clear stage of development.

- [ ] **Public technical evidence**

  Screenshots or safe public repository; no private secrets or unpublished sensitive IP.

- [ ] **Teammate bios**

  Accurate contributions, majors and contact profiles.

- [ ] **30-second verbal explanation**

  Problem, built invention, live result and target user.

- [ ] **Follow-up plan**

  Capture contacts, thank judges, document feedback and prioritise next experiments.

Evidence: [T 27:15-34:00; 45:15-46:45].

Agent operations manual: working protocol

Instructions designed to be pasted into an autonomous research and ideation agent alongside this document.

SYSTEM ROLE

You are a rigorous technology research partner helping a Louisiana college team prepare for the 2026 Nexus Technology Cup. Optimize for a real working prototype, evidenced impact, meaningful technical difficulty, clear differentiation, and feasible next steps. You are NOT a cheerleader or a generic pitch writer.

Evidence hierarchy and source tags

Tier	What it means	How to use it
T	User-provided October 2 information-session transcript.	Primary source for stated judging philosophy, demo format and Q&A.;
W1-W2	Official 2026 competition page and actual application.	Highest priority for track rules, form fields, dates/prizes.
W3-W4	Official 2025 Nexus reports.	Historical judges, finalist selection and winner descriptions.
W5-W14	Current reputable press, LSU reports, company/paper context.	Corroboration or additional technical detail.
E	User's 2026 organizer email.	Deadline, prize amounts, and high-school stipend statement.
A	Our hypotheses, synthesized lessons and demo templates.	Always label as advice, NEVER as official rules.

Agent must do

- Treat the four official judge dimensions as first-class headings for every project analysis.
- Conduct live competitor, literature, patents and GitHub research before declaring novelty.
- Ask for team skills, time available, existing projects, data access, hardware budget and advisor access.
- Give each claim a confidence level and explicit source or label it "assumption".
- Design a 60- to 90-second core demo before proposing a feature roadmap.
- Present an honest technical baseline, experiment, target metric and failure modes.

- Preserve a searchable decision log of researched ideas, rejected alternatives and remaining questions.
- Use current application form if rules or deadlines may have changed.

Copy-ready agent prompt: brainstorm and select

This is a prompt template, not competition-specific evidence.

Agent instruction block

ROLE

You are a technical venture researcher and skeptical judge for the 2026 Nexus Technology Cup College Track. Work from the official sources and the October 2 session evidence in this dossier. Clearly distinguish facts from hypotheses.

TEAM INPUTS

Ask for current student status and Louisiana institution; individual skills; available hours; known problems; existing prototypes; available devices/data; advisor; collaborator roles; budget; and risk constraints.

RESEARCH TASK

Generate 15 problem-led directions across relevant sectors. For each, find 3 to 5 direct competitors, at least 2 technical or open-source references, an evidence-based user pain, and a precise potential novel contribution. If sources cannot be verified, write UNKNOWN.

FIRST PASS

Score each idea privately on impact, difficulty, novelty, feasibility, demo clarity, ethics/data and team fit. State that these weights are unofficial. Kill any direction requiring inaccessible equipment or data before October 25.

SHORTLIST

Return the best 3 as compact project briefs with: one-sentence claim; buyer/user; core workflow; exact technical architecture; baseline and evaluation; failure modes; 7-day MVP; 2-minute demo; what a judge could criticize.

RED TEAM

Try to defeat the three ideas by finding stronger competing solutions or proofs of low difficulty. Revise or eliminate the weak ones.

DELIVERABLE

Recommend only one build direction with an implementation plan and a traceable argument for impact, difficulty, novelty and feasibility. Explicitly label all facts still awaiting validation.

NEVER FABRICATE A WINNING PREDICTION

There is no publicly verified numerical judging formula, and the 2025 winners were not proof that a particular category will dominate in 2026. Any "win probability" expressed as a number without real data is speculation.

Copy-ready agent prompt: implement and evaluate

Hand this template to a coding agent only after the team selects an idea and approves its constraints.

BUILD CONTRACT

Create the smallest honest end-to-end implementation proving the candidate's unique technical idea. Prefer one highly credible flow to a dozen incomplete features. Clearly document external models, APIs, data and open source dependencies.

ACCEPTANCE TESTS

Specify test inputs, expected outputs and pass conditions before coding. Test normal, adverse and out-of-distribution cases, plus integration failure. Log actual results and avoid claiming external validation.

NOVELTY EVIDENCE

Implement a baseline representing the simplest existing approach. Compare on a justified metric such as factual support, latency, false alerts, cost, memory, recall or task completion.

DEMO REQUIREMENTS

Produce a reproducible 60- to 90-second flow showing problem, input, key processing, output and differentiator. Provide a longer backup demo recording and readable screenshots.

ARTIFACTS

Produce README, architecture diagram, install/run instructions, test script, limitations file, source list, license/privacy notes, attribution log and application-ready video outline.

STOP CONDITIONS

Stop or escalate if data privacy is violated, false claims are required, legal/clinical/safety claims exceed evidence, IP disclosures are at risk, or hardware access is impossible.

COMPLETION

Report what works, what does not, what was simulated, test metrics with sample size, remaining risks, and the exact content that can honestly be placed into the Nexus application.

Application answer scaffolds for the agent

Never fill these templates with made-up achievements. Use only verifiable team-specific evidence.

Question 1: What problem are you trying to solve?

FILL-IN TEMPLATE

"[Specific user] encounters [specific recurring problem] when [situation]. Today they rely on [workflow/alternative], which causes [measured or observed cost]. Our team has built [functional prototype] to address [bounded aspect of the problem]."

Question 2: What makes your product innovative?

FILL-IN TEMPLATE

"Existing [closest solutions] handle [common capability], but struggle with [validated gap]. Our implementation uses [specific method] to enable [demonstrated difference]. The core novel technical work is [team-written components]. We compared against [baseline] using [real test protocol/results]."

Question 3: Who is the target customer or user?

FILL-IN TEMPLATE

"The primary users are [precise segment], especially those who [condition]. Our prototype currently supports [scope]. We verified this problem through [observations, interviews, credible reports] and are testing it with [specific, permissioned group or dataset]."

Video outline for the application

01 **Introduce**

Team members briefly state project and their roles.

02 **Frame the user pain**

Show a concrete problem example in 20 to 30 seconds.

03 **Demonstrate**

Real input, hard subsystem in action, real result.

04 **Differentiate**

Show one comparison or empirical benchmark.

05 **Close accurately**

Current scope, limitations, next steps, advisor and source notes.

The application does not publish a mandatory video length in the parsed page, so this is an outline rather than an official time requirement. [W2]

October 2 session timeline: complete digest

A navigational index back to the ~51-minute user-supplied recording and transcript.

Timestamp	Content and takeaway
00:00-05:00	Tony introduces Nexus, 1992 founding and science-fair inspiration.
05:00-07:10	Why Tech Cup is a real-technology demo rather than idea/pitch-deck contest.
07:50-11:50	Official four criteria: impact, difficulty, novelty, feasibility.
11:50-16:55	Louisiana eligibility, High School and College tracks; faculty advisor.
16:55-19:10	Open Track; student teams may compete up.
19:10-22:25	Non-dilutive prizes; recipients; breakdown by track.
22:25-26:45	Most Innovative eligibility; Encore CO2 and FarmMind history.
27:15-34:00	Why finalists benefit: feedback, media, headshots, networking.
33:45-36:50	Patents not required; public disclosure considerations.
36:50-38:15	2025 submission counts and expected 2026 growth.
38:15-40:25	Degree-of-difficulty comments favor hard tech over trivial AI wrappers.
40:25-41:40	Application, semifinal review and top 10 finalist selection per track.
41:40-46:45	Stage format, slides, prerecorded demo, 10+5 minutes and coaching.
46:45-47:35	All prize-receiving team members must be on the application.
47:35-50:40	Use university experts, coaches and Tech Tailgate events.
50:40-51:10	Closing encouragement and invitation to attend finals.

The October 2 session included optional Tech Tailgates at Southern University, LSU around October 17, and Tulane around October 24. Event specifics should be rechecked rather than treated as eligibility requirements. [T 48:15-50:35]

Uncertainties, conflicts and research boundary

A responsible AI agent must preserve these gaps instead of overwriting them with guesses.

- [ ] **Exact scoring math**

  Four criteria explicitly named, but no official percentages or scoring sheet available in reviewed sources.

- [ ] **Exact finalists' past presentations**

  2025 winner descriptions and one Encore live demonstration anecdote are verified. Full slide decks, full videos and judges' questions were not verified.

- [ ] **2025 contestant counts**

  June official judges article: 74 applicants, 44 semifinalists, 21 finalists; later reports/speakers give different counts. Preserve source date.

- [ ] **2025 Encore award**

  Contemporaneous reporting says $45,000 combined; session speaker retrospectively recalled another total. Use documented June figure.

- [ ] **2026 finals timing**

  Session mentioned December 12, current event page and current coverage say December 14-16.

- [ ] **College grade eligibility**

  Transcript verbally emphasized undergraduates; current official page includes undergraduate and graduate students.

- [ ] **Teacher advisor stipend**

  User email says $250 for qualifying high schools; official site shows $2,500 for teacher advisors. Confirm exact distribution.

- [ ] **Patent status**

  Session says patent not required or prioritised, but current application asks whether patented.

- [ ] **Dual-track applications**

  Applying up from college to Open allowed per session; concurrent applications to both tracks not verified.

- [ ] **2026 finalist count**

  Session announced planned top 10 per track. Current site does not spell out whether organizers can adjust totals.

SOURCE PRECEDENCE WHEN INFORMATION CHANGES

For enrollment, deadlines, prizes and venue, prioritize the current official competition page and actual application over older recordings. For subjective judging philosophy and presentation advice, prioritize the October 2 session. Keep discrepancies visible and verify with organizers.

Cited research sources and direct links

Links here are clickable in the PDF. All references were relevant as of October 8, 2026.

[T] October 2, 2026 Nexus Technology Cup info-session video; user provided transcript
https://youtu.be/6oSM2F4KBTw

[E] Organizer email supplied by user, with deadline and prize table (no public URL)

[W1] Official 2026 Nexus Technology Cup overview, dates, tracks, prize details
https://www.nexusla.org/programs/tech-cup

[W2] Live 2026 Nexus Technology Cup application form (Jotform)
https://form.jotform.com/261315127654050

[W3] Nexus official 2025 judges and applicant selection news
https://www.nexusla.org/articles/nexus-louisiana-announces-judges-for-the-2025-technology-cup

[W4] Nexus official 2025 College Track winners and judges
https://www.nexusla.org/articles/farmsmarter-ai-wins-top-prize-in-nexus-technology-cup-college-track-finals

[W5] Technical.ly September/October 2026 story on deadline, 2026 and 2025 results
https://technical.ly/entrepreneurship/how-to-apply-nexus-technology-cup-louisiana/

[W6] Nexus Louisiana About page, institutional mission and people
https://www.nexusla.org/about

[W7] Nexus 30th Anniversary Report, history since 1992
https://nexusla.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/NEXUS-30TH-Anniversary-Report-Digital.pdf

[W8] Business Report June 2025 winners, Encore, FarmSmarter and other podium teams
https://www.businessreport.com/encore-co2-lsu-team-win-top-honors-at-inaugural-nexus-technology-cup/

[W9] Technical.ly 2026 retrospective identifies FarmMind and all track medalists
https://technical.ly/entrepreneurship/how-to-apply-nexus-technology-cup-louisiana/

[W10] Nexus official 2025 complete finalist roster and contact
https://www.nexusla.org/articles/nexus-louisiana-announces-the-finalists-of-the-technology-cup

[W11] LSU College of Business on FarmSmarter product and mentor support
https://www.lsu.edu/business/news/2025/5/homegrown-team-finds-startup-success-with-lsu-resources-may-2025.php

[W12] ACM CHI EA 2025 publication index on AI and crowdsourcing for misinformation
https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3720007

[W13] University of Louisiana Monroe reporting on Dristi team
https://www.ulm.edu/news/2025/nexus_cup_071625.html

[W14] Build-A-Way project finalist reporting
https://bizneworleans.com/nexus-cup-finalist-build-a-way-offers-voice-ai-for-trades/

Required diligence before you hand the project to another agent

Give the agent the **PDF plus the companion Markdown context**, the actual project repository or screenshots, advisor contacts you are authorized to share, relevant datasets and an explicit time budget. Ask for a fresh check of current deadlines and competition policies. This dossier contains research and synthesis; it does not grant external data permissions or substitute for organizer confirmation.